Payment Of Salaries/Wages

Paying wages on the due date is the responsibility of every employer. Private sector employers should ensure to pay their staff's salaries through the Wages Protection System to avoid penalties and fines.

Report Unpaid Or Delayed Salaries

For any concerns or complaints regarding salary payment in the private sector, workers may contact Ministry of Human Resources and Emiratisation (MoHRE) or register a salary complaint.

Wages are paid in accordance to Ministerial Resolution No. 598 of 2022 Regarding Wages Protection System.

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When Should Employers Pay Salaries?

All establishments registered with Ministry of Human Resources and Emiratisation (MoHRE) must pay their employees' wages on the due date through the ministry's Wage Protection System (WPS). The employee's wages are due from the first day of the month following the expiry of the period for which the wages are specified in the employment contract.

If the period is not specified in the employment contract, the employee must be paid at least once a month.

The employer is considered late in paying the wage if the payment is not made within the first 15 days after the due date, unless the employment contract specifies a shorter period.

Minimum Wages

There is no minimum salary stipulated in the UAE Labour Law. However, it includes general provisions requiring that wages must be sufficient to meet the basic needs of employees.

How Should Salaries/Wages Be Paid?

Under the WPS, salaries of private sector employees will be transferred through banks, exchange houses or financial institutions authorised by the Central Bank of the UAE to provide the service.

The WPS was developed by the UAE Central Bank, enabling MoHRE to establish a database of wage payments in the private sector and monitor employers' compliance with paying wages in full and on

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time.

Payment can be in Emirati Dirham, or in any other currency if it is agreed upon between both parties in the employment contract.

Penalties On Companies For Late Or Non-Payment Of Salaries/Wages

The table below lists penalties for companies failing to pay salaries/wages on the due dates:

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Deadline	Targeted Establishments	Action
1. By the due date	All establishments	• Electronic monitoring will be performed on establishments to ensure compliance with the payment of wages.
2. In the third and tenth days following the due date		• Reminders and notifications will be sent to defaulting establishments in regards to the payment of wages.
3. By the Seventeenth day after the due date	All establishments	• Issuance of new work permits for the establishment is suspended. A notification explaining the reasons for the suspension will be sent to the employer.
	Establishment employing more than 50 employees	• Defaulting establishments will be listed in the Electronic Monitoring and Inspection System and inspections will be scheduled. An inspector will conduct inspections and issue warnings as necessary
		• In addition to notifying the

4. 45 days after the due date	Establishment employing more than 50 employees	public prosecutor, the establishment details will be forwarded to the competent authorities at the federal and local levels in order to pursue legal action as appropriate. The concerned department within the Ministry will follow up on these actions.
5. In the event that the establishment commits the violation again within six months	Establishments with wage-related labor complaints referred to the judiciary	• Consequently, the following actions will be taken: • According to Cabinet Resolution No. (21) of 2020, an administrative fine will be imposed. • Reclassify the establishment to category (3) in accordance with the aforementioned Ministerial Resolution No.(209) of 2022.

Source: Ministerial Resolution No. 598 of 2022 Regarding Wages Protection System

Categories Excluded From WPS Compliance

The following categories of employees are excluded from the WPS:

- those who filed a wage-related labour complaint that has been referred to the judiciary

- those who have been reported absent as per a ‘work abandonment’ report
- new employees during the first 30 days from the due date of the wage
- those who are on unpaid leave, provided that supporting documents are duly submitted to MoHRE

Additionally, the following categories of employers are excluded from the WPS compliance:

- UAE nationals owning fishing boats
- UAE nationals owning public taxis
- Banks
- houses of worship.

*Text provided by MoHRE

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